

hypethesis

Gmail

■ What is it?

Gmail is Google's free e-mail offering. It's not yet publically available, but selected customers have been given accounts for testing and reviewing purposes.

■ How does it work?

When you use Gmail, the text of your e-mails is read by computers, and ads relevant to the subject matter are displayed with your incoming mail.

Google assures us that no humans will read the e-mail, and that nothing that can identify, the sender or the receiver, is given out to the advertisers.

■ What does it do?

Gmail gives an unbelievable 1,000 MB of space. Currently, POP3 and automatic forwarding are not offered.

A sophisticated search engine will help search within archived e-mails. All e-mails and replies are grouped as conversations.

Customers get a spam filter, as well as mail filters.

snapshot

RFID applications deployed will increase **450% in 2005**, and a further **96% in 2006**

Source: www.evansdata.com

Waiter, there's mustard on my laptop...

And if McDonald's has its way, maybe mayoan-aise, tomato ketchup and a little bit of Georgia coffee too could suddenly find residence in the crevices of your laptop's keyboard.

And so dear readers, join your hands in welcoming Wi-Fi connectivity at more than 3000 McDonald's outlets across the US by the end of the year, a trend that we hope find its way into Asia, and also India.

Wayport, an Austin (Texas)-based company, has already provided wireless access to 300

McDonalds outlets as part of a pilot project. It will eventually Wi-Fi all of the 10,000-odd Mac outlets across USA.



Illustrations: Farzana Cooper

McDonalds will charge \$2.95 (approx Rs 140) for two-hour access, while regulars can opt for a monthly plan priced

at \$29.95 (approx Rs 1,350).

Of course, McDonald's is not the first food chain to offer Wi-Fi access. Last year, Starbucks Coffee added Wi-Fi to its already bloated 45-kinds-of-coffee-menu.

Our worry, though, is not about McDonalds or Starbucks making enough money out of renting Wi-Fi services, or the resulting rise in burger and coffee sales. Our worry is how would the users keep the laptop clean as they eat and work simultaneously.

Any ideas?

Happy birthday, spam!

Spam celebrated a decade in April, and we thought we'd tell you 10 things about the 10-year old:

■ The term 'spam' originated in 1937, when Kenneth Daigneau won \$100 for coming up with a name to replace Hormel Foods' canned meat-based product, then known as Hormel Spiced Ham.

■ Laurence Canter and Martha Siegel, a lawyer pair, take the credit for sending the first spam mail in 1994, creating what many call the second biggest bane of the Net, after child pornography.

■ The spam business is valued at \$20 billion (Rs 90,000 crore) per year.

■ New York became the first state in the USA to prosecute a spammer with imprisonment.

■ The Nigerian spam e-mail (people actually responded to



it), is believed to have defrauded Internet users of up to \$19.8 million.

■ The first national spam law in US is called the Controlling

the Assault of Non-Solicited Pornography and Marketing Act (Can-Spam).

■ The most popular spam pitches include—Viagra, debt, insurance rates, porn sites and online degrees.

■ There are numerous estimates about how much of all mail is spam, but several estimates say that one in six mails is.

■ There is a 16,500 sq ft Spam Museum in Austin, Minnesota, US.

■ Howard Carmack, a US-based professional spammer, sent more than 857 million messages last year. He's been found liable for \$16.4 million in damages, along with charges of criminal fraud in New York.

■ VMware to soon support the 64-bit editions of Windows XP and Linux ■ 3Com opens up engineering design centre in Hyderabad